

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 794

By Shaw

A RESOLUTION to propose an amendment to Article XI, Section 5 of the Constitution of Tennessee, to allow for bingo events to benefit certain organizations.

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that a majority of all the members of each house concurring, as shown by the yeas and nays entered on their journals, that it is proposed that Article XI, Section 5 of the Constitution of the State of Tennessee be amended by adding the following language at the end of the section:

This Section does not prohibit bingo games, as defined below, when conducted by a tax-exempt 501(c)(3) or 501(c)(19) organization, as defined by the 2000 United States Tax Code, to meet charitable, nonprofit, or community service purposes. Bingo games authorized in this section shall be implemented and administered uniformly throughout the state in such manner as the legislature, by general law, deems appropriate.

"Bingo" means a specific game of chance in which participants use an electronic or manual playing surface divided into horizontal and vertical spaces, each of which is designated by a letter and a number, and prizes are awarded on the basis of the letters and numbers on the playing surface conforming to a predetermined and preannounced configuration of letters and numbers selected at random.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the foregoing amendment be referred to the One Hundred Fifteenth General Assembly and that this resolution proposing such amendment be published in compliance with Article XI, Section 3 of the Constitution of Tennessee by posting

such amendment on the official website of the Secretary of State and on the official website of the General Assembly.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.